Lawmakers return to Capitol to tackle high-profile bills

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Author: Andrew Sheeler; Staff Writer | Section: News | 249 Words
Page: 2A
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Summer break is over, and the halls of the Capitol are once more teeming with lawmakers, staffers and lobbyists as they go about the people's business.

On Monday, they're jumping back into the mix, with the Senate Appropriations Committee set to hold a hearing on many bills we've been following this year.

There's AB 28, Assemblyman Jesse Gabriel's proposal for an excise tax on firearms and ammunition. The money would go toward gun violence prevention programs.

AB 38, by Assemblyman Alex Lee, would establish standards for light pollution in residential zones.

Assemblyman Chris Holden's AB 280 would restrict the use of solitary confinement in California jails or prisons. Gov. Gavin Newsom vetoed a previous version.

Another bill up for consideration during Monday's hearing is the so-called Skittles Bill. AB 418 by Assemblyman Gabriel, would ban certain chemicals from being used in foods and beverages.

Assemblyman Corey Jackson's AB 1078, which would require school boards to accurately portray California's cultural and racial diversity, will also be considered.

Meanwhile, the Assembly Appropriations Committee returns with a hearing on Wednesday.

Lawmakers will take up a number of measures, including SB 14, Sen. Shannon Grove's bill to make child sex trafficking a three strikes felony; SB 58, Sen. Scott Wiener's proposal to decriminalize certain psychedelics; SB 403, by Sen. Aisha Wahab, which would add caste to the list of statuses covered by the state's anti-discrimination law, and SB 447, Sen. Toni Atkins' bill to replace California's travel ban with a LGBTQ advocacy program.

Andrew Sheeler: 916-326-5502, @andrewsheeler

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